Year 4 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Maths question 11 now says to write the length in cm and mm. Use with `Y04/Y04_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

Who this is for. Students applying for Year 4 are usually 8 years old on 1 September. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 2** (二年级): numbers to 10 000, adding and subtracting, times tables to 9 × 9 and division facts, cm and m, g and kg, time to the minute, right angles and simple tables of data. Fractions, perimeter, area, millimetres and multiplying by a one-digit number usually come in Grade 3. English as a school subject often starts in Grade 3, so many students have only had English classes outside school; students from bilingual schools may be close to fluent.

How it works. About 59 minutes of student time, plus a welcome and a short break. The student writes in the **Student paper** (20 pages). Listening, reading, writing and maths can be taken in a small group with one invigilator (the listening is played or read to the group); the interview with sentence reading is always 1:1. Mark everything the same day and record the results as in Section 5, ending with the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

1. At a glance

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student paper	You need
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	page 1	Section 2 of these instructions
2	Listening (recording)	about 7	Assessor plays the recording or reads the script; students answer	pages 2 to 3	The recording, or the script in Section 3.1
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C	12	Students work alone	pages 4 to 10	A clock or timer
4	Writing	10	Students work alone	pages 11 to 12	
	Break	3 to 5			Water; a chance to move
5	Maths: Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures)	18	Students work alone; you read any question on request	pages 13 to 20	Pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm and mm
6	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start at Level 3)	12	Interviewer, 1:1		Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`), Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`), Reading front sheet, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, a plain card
	Total	**about 59**, plus welcome and break			

For each candidate:

- the Student paper (A4, single-sided, at actual size);
- the grading sheet (`Y04/Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 3 and 4 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`), laminated;
- a clock or timer, and a plain card to cover sentences;
- the listening recording (`audio/v3.1/Y04/`) and something to play it on.

2. Before you start

The room. Quiet and bright, with space between desks. Each student has a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. Keep the door open or another adult present.

Pace of speech. Year 4 students are still learning English: speak clearly and a little slower than you would to a fluent speaker, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Say: "Hello, everyone. My name is [your name]. I am a teacher here. Today you will do some listening, reading, writing and maths, and then you will talk with a teacher. These activities help us get to know you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question."

Help each student write their name and the date on page 1. Point to the "How to answer" box and say: "This shows you how to answer. Tick a box like this. Write in a box like this. Show your working like this."

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections: listening, reading, writing, sentence reading	**Maths**
Reading aloud	Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or questions for the student. You may repeat an instruction in English.	Read any question aloud in English, at the pace above, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Write **L** by the question and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

Codes. NT not yet taught: the student says they have not learnt it; it scores 0 and is listed on the grading sheet. **L** language support in maths, also listed on the grading sheet. Record extra time, a reader or any other access arrangement for a known need on the grading sheet.

Stopping and keeping students at ease. Any student may stop a section when they have done what they can: they turn over and wait quietly. Praise effort, not answers. If a student is upset, give them a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet. Never press a distressed child. At the end of each timed part, let students finish the question they are on, then move on together.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 7 minutes with the recording, student paper pages 2 to 3)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y04/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It says the instructions below, reads the eight questions aloud once, plays the script twice (20 seconds apart) and gives one minute to finish, so you do not say or read anything yourself. The two speakers have different voices, so it does not say their names. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of the script takes about 1 minute 52 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Say: "Turn to page 2, Part 1: Listening. You are going to hear a phone call. Li Na is talking to her friend Amir. I will read it two times. First, look at the questions with me."

Read the eight questions aloud, once, without the answer choices: "Question 1. Where are they going on Saturday? Question 2. What time will they meet? Question 3. Where is the bus stop? Question 4. What must Amir bring? Tick two pictures. Question 5. What will Grandma make for lunch? Question 6. How old is Amir's brother? Question 7. Why does Amir's brother not need a ticket? Question 8. How does Amir feel about the trip? How do you know?"

Say: "Now listen. You can answer while you listen, and after."

Read it twice clearly and steadily, a little slower than normal speech, with a short pause after each sentence. Change your voice a little for the two speakers, but do not act. Do not stress the answers. Leave about 20 seconds between the two readings, and about 1 minute after the second reading for students to finish.

> **A phone call**
>
> **Li Na:** Hello, Amir. It's Li Na.
>
> **Amir:** Hi, Li Na!
>
> **Li Na:** Are you free on Saturday? My grandma is taking me to the zoo. Last time we went to the park, but this time we're going to the zoo. Can you come with us? [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yes, please! I love the zoo. What time are you going?
>
> **Li Na:** Grandma wanted to go at eight o'clock, but that's very early. So we're going to meet at nine o'clock. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Nine o'clock. OK. Where?
>
> **Li Na:** At the bus stop. Not the bus stop near our school. The bus stop next to the supermarket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** OK, next to the supermarket. What do I need to bring?
>
> **Li Na:** Bring a hat, because it will be sunny. You don't need an umbrella. And bring some water. Don't bring any lunch. Grandma is making dumplings for everyone. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Yum! I love dumplings. Can my little brother come too? He's five.
>
> **Li Na:** I'll ask Grandma. [pause] She says yes! Children under six don't need a ticket. [pause]
>
> **Amir:** Brilliant! I can't wait. See you on Saturday!
>
> **Li Na:** Bye, Amir!

Answers (1 mark each)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	A (the zoo)		B (the park: they went last time)
2	B (9 o'clock)		A (8 o'clock: Grandma's first idea)
3	B (next to the supermarket)		A (near school)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
4	A and C (hat and water)		Any other picture ticked, or only one ticked
5	dumplings	Any spelling that is clearly "dumplings": dumpling, damplins, dumplins	noodles; Chinese characters or pinyin (饺子, jiaozi): note it, as it shows understanding
6	5	five, fiv	6
7	He is five / under six, and children under six do not need a ticket.	"He is under six." "He is five." "Because he is small and children under six are free."	"He is small" or "he is a child" with no age; "Grandma pays"
8	A positive feeling **and** a reason from the call: "He is excited because he says 'Brilliant' / 'I can't wait' / 'I love the zoo' / 'Yes, please'."	happy, glad, pleased, can't wait, excited; the reason may be in the student's own words ("he wants to go a lot")	A feeling with no reason; a negative feeling

Total: 8 marks.

Band guide: 0 to 2 **A**; 3 to 4 **B**; 5 to 6 **C**; 7 **D**; 8 **E**.

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 3 each have a distractor that is also said (the park, eight o'clock, the school). Choosing the distractor means the student caught a familiar word but not "last time", "but" or "not": typical of band B.
- Questions 5 and 6 need one heard word. A clear but misspelt word still scores: it is a listening task.
- Questions 7 and 8 need the student to join two pieces of information or read Amir's feelings. Students who score these are following connected talk (bands D and E).

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, student paper pages 4 to 10)

Say: "Turn to page 4, Part 2: Reading. There are three texts: a menu, a story and a text about honeybees. Read each text and answer the questions. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Do not read any text or question aloud. Tell the students when there are 2 minutes left.

The three parts get harder. **Part A** is a menu with pictures. **Part B** is a short story written about two years below age level. **Part C** is **non-fiction** (an information text about honeybees, with a labelled diagram) at the level of a fluent 8 year old reader, and it is meant to stretch.

Answers (1 mark each unless stated). Spelling does not matter if the answer is clear, except where the question asks the student to copy a word.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
		Part A: the menu		
1	Retrieval	Happy Panda Café	Happy Panda Cafe; Happy Panda	Panda; Café
2	Retrieval	¥12	12	15, 14
3	Retrieval	10	ten	2 (counted the dumplings in the picture)
4	Retrieval	apple juice		
5	Retrieval	11 am	11, 11 o'clock, eleven, 11:00	8 pm
6	Retrieval	Monday	Mon	Tuesday; Sunday
7	Retrieval and simple inference (2 marks)	Ice cream: **True**. Water costs ¥2: **False**	1 mark for each correct row	
		Part B: The Paper Boats		
8	Retrieval	paper boats		

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
9	Retrieval	blue		red (Wang Hao's boat)
10	Retrieval	to the pond in the park	"the pond"; "the park"; "a pond"	"home"; "the sea"; "on the water" with no place
11	Sequencing (2 marks)	Went down: **3**. Made boats: 1 (given). Thick paper: **4**. Put on the water: **2**	2 marks for all three correct; 1 mark if two neighbouring events are swapped	
12	Vocabulary (find and copy)	sad		worry (Tom's word); happy
13	Simple inference	It got wet (the paper got wet).	"The paper was wet." "Paper and water." "The paper was thin."	"It was old." "The wind."
14	Simple inference	Wang Hao used thick paper and coloured it with wax crayons.	Either idea: "thick paper" or "wax crayons"; "the paper was strong"	"It was red." "Tom helped."
		Part C: Honeybees: Busy Workers (non-fiction)		
15	Retrieval	a hive		a cell (the tiny wax rooms); a nest
16	Retrieval	to lay eggs	"lay eggs"; "make eggs"	"she is the biggest"; "make honey"
17	Retrieval	young workers	young bees; the young (worker) bees	the queen; older workers
18	Vocabulary in context	shakes		
19	Retrieval and inference	To tell the other bees which way to fly and how far to go (where the flowers are).	"To show where the flowers are." "To tell them the way."	"Because she is happy." "To have fun."
20	Inference	Bees carry pollen from flower to flower, and this helps plants make fruit.	"Bees help the plants make fruit." "No bees to carry pollen."	"Bees eat the apples." "Apples need honey."
21	Inference	So the bee is not frightened and does not sting you; it will fly away.	"So it does not sting you." "Bees sting when they are scared." "It will fly away."	"Because bees are bad." "To catch it."
22	Author's purpose (why do you think)	To show the parts of a bee / what a bee looks like / to help the reader understand the words.	"So we can see the wings, legs and sting." "To help you understand."	"Because it is nice." "To colour it."

Part A (Questions 1 to 7): 8 marks. Part B (Questions 8 to 14): 8 marks. Part C (Questions 15 to 22): 8 marks. Total: 24 marks.

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B**
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C**
Part C 3 to 5	**D**
Part C 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C score with a low Part B score usually means the student rushed or ran out of time), and check against the sentence reading screen. Record the reading paper marks and the reading band on the **Reading front sheet** and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Strong readers** finish Part C, answer in their own words and give reasons ("because ...").
- **Decoding ahead of understanding:** a good sentence reading score but weak Part B and Part C answers, or answers copied from the wrong place in the text. Common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet outside school.
- **An English barrier, not a reading difficulty:** correct answers that are hard to read ("so it not scard and sting") still score.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, student paper pages 11 to 12)

Say: "Turn to page 11, Part 3: Writing. There are two tasks. Choose one task and tick the box. Task 1 is a story about a big egg. Task 2 is about your favourite day of the year. Use the plan box first if you want to. Then write on page 12. You have 10 minutes." You may read the two task boxes aloud once. Do not give words, spellings or ideas.

The two tasks

- **Task 1: The big egg** (story, with a picture). "Jun and Sofia find a very big egg in the park. Write a story. What is inside the egg? What happens next?"
- **Task 2: My favourite day of the year** (my favourite). "Write about your favourite day of the year. When is it? What do you do? Who is with you? Why do you like it?"

The four criteria. Score each from 0 to 4; 1 and 3 fall between the descriptions.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	No English writing on the task, or only copied words.	A few connected sentences on the task, with a simple order (a beginning and an end, or a short list of things they do).	A complete piece that suits the task: a story with a beginning, an event or problem and an ending, or a description with several points and reasons. Ideas grouped in paragraphs or clear sections.
Vocabulary	No English words of the student's own.	Everyday words, often repeated (nice, good, big, go, play).	Varied, precise words for the age (cracked, peeped, wobbled, delicious, lanterns, excited) and some longer noun phrases ("a huge spotted egg").
Grammar and sentences	No sentence.	Simple sentences with frequent errors in tense, plurals and "a" and "the"; ideas joined mostly with "and" and "then".	Mostly accurate sentences, a range of joining words (because, when, so, but, if, after), tense kept the same, some variety (a question, some speech).
Spelling and punctuation	Very few words can be read.	Common words mostly right; other words spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops some of the time.	Most words right, including common Year 2 and Year 3 words; capital letters, full stops, question marks and commas in lists used correctly; perhaps speech marks or apostrophes.

Total: 16 marks (four criteria, each out of 4).

Writing band (best fit). Read the piece against the band descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and choose the band that fits best, not the total alone. As a rough guide: about 0 to 3 **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

What band E looks like at this age. In 10 minutes, about 10 to 14 lines or more: a story with a clear beginning, middle and end, or an organised description with reasons; sentences joined with because, when, so and if; the tense kept the same; some well-chosen words and longer phrases; common words spelt correctly; capital letters, full stops and question marks used correctly, perhaps with speech marks. This is what a fluent English-speaking child at the end of UK Year 3 writes.

What to look for

- Missing past tense and plural endings and missing "a" and "the" are normal for a learner of English. Judge how much the student can communicate and organise.
- A long, well-organised piece with many grammar errors (band C or D) shows a student who will make fast progress with support; a short, accurate piece may show a cautious writer: compare with the interview.
- Task 2 is easier to write from memory; Task 1 needs imagination. Note which task was chosen on the grading sheet.

3.4 Interview with sentence reading (12 minutes, 1:1)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4` and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`). The interview opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the rules, the interviewer's copy of the sentences and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the record is the **Reading front sheet**): **start at Level 3** (sentence 7) and follow the start, going back and stopping rules in the guide (about 3 to 4 minutes). Then hold the interview: speak at the pace in Section 2, choose about two questions from each block, and give the **speaking band** on the Interview sheet. The interview also gives a "listening in conversation" band: compare it with the listening task. To finish, thank the student and tell them one thing they did well. Do not give any results.

4. Maths (18 minutes, student paper pages 13 to 20)

Say: "Turn to page 13, Part 4: Maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. I can read any question to you. Just put your hand up. You have 18 minutes. Do not use a calculator."

- **Equipment:** pencil, rubber, ruler. No calculator.
- **Reading aloud:** read any question in English, at the pace in Section 2, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture. The word problems are Questions 10, 12, 14b and 17. In a group, go to the student and read quietly. The Chinese reading is once only, by a colleague, after the English: write **L** and list it on the grading sheet.
- **Time:** about 6 minutes for Section A and 12 for Section B. Tell the students when there are 5 minutes left. If a student says they have not learnt something, write **NT** and list it on the grading sheet.
- Questions 7 and 16b are Year 4 content, there to find the ceiling. A Year 4 entrant is not expected to get them.

Mark scheme. One mark for each answer unless the table says otherwise. Type: **N** number problem, **W** word problem, **P** problem with a picture, chart or diagram.

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
		Section A: Number problems			
1	N	76; 84		Floor questions (UK Year 2 work).	2
2	N	574; 257		564 (did not carry). 343 for the second (took the smaller digit from the larger in each column). Column subtraction with two exchanges may not have been taught (Chinese Grade 3).	2
3	N	21; 32		Usually strong: times tables to 9 × 9 are Grade 2 work.	2
4	N	7			1
5	N	92		812 (8 and 12 written side by side) or 82 (forgot to carry). Multiplying a two-digit number may not have been taught (Grade 3); a student may still use 23 + 23 + 23 + 23.	1
6	N	$^3/_5$	three fifths; 五分之三 (write L)	$^3/_{10}$ (added the bottom numbers too). Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	1
7	N	372		Year 4 content. May not have been taught (Grade 3).	1

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
		Section B: Word problems and pictures			
8	P	406		46 (no zero for the empty tens column): place value not secure.	1
9	P	6		14 (added 10 and 4). 4 or 10 (read one bar only).	1
10	W	24	24 mooncakes	11 (added 8 and 3) suggests the question was not understood: read it again.	1
11	P	5 cm 6 mm	56 mm written in the mm box; 5.6 cm; 5.6 cm and 56 mm (both ways)	5 cm 5 mm or 5 cm 7 mm. Millimetres may not have been taught (Grade 3).	1
12	W	57 cm	57	127 (added). 63 (took the smaller digit from the larger: 5 – 2). 67 (exchanged a ten but did not take it from the tens).	1
13	P	a A and C; b horizontal G, vertical F		a: both A and C, and nothing else, for the mark. Students who tick only A have not recognised a turned right angle. b: both letters for the mark. The words "horizontal" and "vertical" may be new in English: read them, but do not explain them.	2
14	P, W	a 10:35; b 35 minutes	a twenty-five to eleven; 35 minutes past 10; 10.35	a: 11:35 (hour hand read as the nearer number); a time starting with 7 (hands swapped). b: 75 (worked 3:20 minus 2:45 as 320 – 245). Time intervals across the hour may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
15	P	a $^{7}/_{10}$; b 2	a seven tenths; 0.7; 十分之七 (write L)	a: $^{3}/_{10}$ (counted the white parts) or $^{7}/_{3}$. Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
16	P	a 18 cm; b 16 squares	b 16 cm², 16 square cm, 16	a: 16 (counted squares, not edges) or 14 (missed the edges at the step). b: Year 4 content. Perimeter and area may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2
17	W	¥8 (2 marks)	8, 8 yuan, 8元	**1 mark** for 4 × 3 = 12 seen, or for ¥20 minus a wrong total worked correctly. 12 alone scores 1.	2

Section A (Questions 1 to 7): 10 marks. Section B (Questions 8 to 17): 15 marks. Total: 25 marks, of which word problems (Questions 10, 12, 14b, 17): 5 marks.

Band guide (provisional, to be reviewed after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 9 **1** Well below expected; 10 to 14 **2** Working towards; 15 to 21 **3** Expected; 22 to 25 **4** Greater depth. List the NT questions on the grading sheet. If they explain a low score, judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Number problems and word problems. The word problems use the same skills as number problems in Section A: Question 10 (3 × 8) with Question 3, Question 12 (92 – 35) with Questions 1 and 2, Question 17 with Questions 3 and 1. A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty: check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L and listed on the grading sheet).

What to look for

- **Strong:** accurate written methods (column addition and subtraction, a written method for 23 × 4), working shown, sensible use of the diagrams, and answers checked against the picture.
- **A maths difficulty:** errors in Section A on taught content (Questions 1, 3 and 4) as well as in Section B; counting in ones on the grid and the bar chart.
- **An English barrier:** a strong Section A but blank or wrong word problems, or many requests to read a question; answers that come quickly once the question has been read aloud or said in Chinese.

Likely not yet taught for a student who has completed Chinese Grade 2: Questions 5 and 7 (multiplying by a one-digit number), 6 and 15 (fractions), 11 (millimetres), 14b (time intervals across the hour) and 16 (perimeter and area).

Question 2 (column methods with exchanges) and Question 9 (bar charts) may also be new. Students from bilingual schools, or who have started Grade 3, may have met some of these.

5. Recording the results

1. Mark the student paper (every question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet (`Y04_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet.
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student paper with them (or shred it under the school's policy).